

NEURO-
SCIENCE
BASED
CAREER &
LIFE DESIGN

FUTURE READY NOW



DR. SWETA ADATIA

Dr. Sweta Adatia is an accomplished Neurologist. She achieved her Masters in Neurology from Mumbai, India, and Stroke Care from the University of Calgary, Canada, and an MBA from the University of Cambridge, UK. She is passionate about understanding the brain and the powers of the Self. Along with mainstream medicine, she has done courses in Hypnotherapy, Crystal Healing, Pranic Healing, Clairvoyance, Aura Photography, Past Life Regression, Neurofeedback, QEEG, Quantum healing, and Interventional pain care.

WHAT DO YOU SEE YOURSELF AS IN THE FUTURE?

"The two most important days in your life are the day you are born and the day you find out why you are born."

Mark Twain

The human brain is a masterpiece of the highest order. Your *braindesign®* determines your *life design®*. The way you think determines the way you behave, communicate, develop relationships, advance in your career, and become successful in life. Everyone is born to succeed. Knowing or not knowing how you are wired is the difference between success and failure. Future Ready Now will make the difference.

Realizing your potential starts with gaining insights into your brain - your inherent aptitude and your unique way of thinking. Future Ready Now will help you manifest your full potential aptitude with the right career choice.

Brain mapping is a masterful art and science. Dr Sweta Adatia is an accomplished and practising Neurologist. Using cutting-edge Neuroscience principles, she has developed the pyramid of career choice success, a 7-pillar process that has been successfully applied to thousands of students globally. Future Ready Now is the result of intense research and first-hand experience spanning over two decades.

Whether you are a high schooler, an under-grad, a post-grad, a parent, a teacher, or a career counsellor, Future Ready Now is a ready reckoner and practical guide for enabling the right career choices to be made with ease and confidence.

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and Life Design

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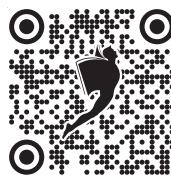
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*This book is dedicated to all **humane** beings.
The human being is endowed but being human is incredible.*

“This book contributes in an extraordinary way to the concept of ‘future-ready’. It is a superb addition to the art and science of career discovery and career choices—Dr Adatia’s approach is fresh, different and prepares students for a world that will keep on changing radically. It is certainly one of the most meaningful publications in this field in the 21st century.”

—Dr Kobus Neethling
Creator of the NBI Whole-Brain Instruments,
Guinness World Record holder, and author of
a number of international publications and TV series.

Table of Contents

Acknowledgements	vii
Introduction	ix
Chapter 1	Arranged-Cum-Love Career: What a Dilemma! 1
Chapter 2	What's all the Fuss About Career Discovery? 19
Chapter 3	The Who, What, When, Where and How of Generation Alpha 37
Chapter 4	The World of Work in the 21st Century: Expect the Unexpected 55
Chapter 5	Is There a Perfect Career Tool? 75
Chapter 6	What <i>is</i> the Difference in the Difference? 93
Chapter 7	<i>Mybraindesign</i> ®: The Secret Source to 'Know Thyself' 109
Chapter 8	The End Point for Your Career Choice is the New Beginning for Your Life 143
Chapter 9	Let's Live By Purpose, and Not By Accident 159
Chapter 10	Flow and Grow: Stretching the Thinking through New Hobbies and Activities 171
Chapter 11	Adult Bonus Chapter 183
Conclusion	203

About the Author	207
Extras	209
Want More Resources?	223
About the Book	227
Testimonials	229

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‘Acknowledging the good that you already have in your life is the foundation for all the abundance.’

— EKHART TOLLE

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I want to *be* more and *do* more. The journey has just begun.

Introduction

What if we could prepare the children and young people in our lives for successful careers and rewarding lives long before the end of their high school education? What if that choice could be built on understanding their unique way of thinking and being in this world, rather than the pressure of having to choose a job to suit their options when they finish college? What if we could 'future-ready' them much earlier, and in doing so, empower them to design life, not just a career?

I have one of the best jobs in the world – I work to help people across the globe (my childhood dream). I help my patients embrace a healthy life and I help to release students/adults stuck in their career choices. I did not land accidentally in this job. I had to endure a roller-coaster ride before I could reach this stage of my life.

I could not have been happier or more fulfilled (accomplished too, I hold a doctorate in neuroscience) if I was merely a 'brain plumber', that is, a neurologist. I often joke in my seminars and say it is very easy to fix a broken brain but difficult to kindle a normal brain. My kick in the morning, waking up each day, is how I help students and adults stuck in their career choices. The happy chemicals – dopamine and serotonin – gush through my brain when I see the joyful and relieved faces of parents and students.

While in my career practice, I can help a few thousand in my lifetime, through building a process that is embraced globally, I can reach a few million. This legacy in career life choices is my endeavour.

My own career journey, from medicine to neurology and an MBA from Cambridge University (one of the top five highest QS ranking universities in the world), forms the catalyst for this book. Curiosity to know myself, or my thinking self, became the force behind the development of *Mybraindesign*® – a tool showcasing how you think and how to best channel that way of thinking into a rewarding career and life.

The brain is complex. It has an outer layer for rational thought and an inner layer for emotional processing. It has multiple cognitive drivers or so-called patterns. No two individuals think the same, not even twins. I was pursuant to knowing how I can align my work to the thinking tendencies that I have. Thought always precedes action. This is not challengeable. How you think will determine how you shall act.

Can I really know how I think? What is my 'brain design'? What is the type of work that best matches my cognitive abilities? Is behaviour predictable? Can we design a career path in high school that anticipates these functions well enough? Can we allow our thinking patterns to be developed and expanded?

The answer to all the questions above is yes, you definitely can. I did not leave a single psychometric tool unstudied in my research. I used about seventy-two tools on myself. I studied their basic methodology in detail. I have spoken to thousands of parents and teachers across the world, and have met a lot of career design enthusiasts.

I am a neuroscience fanatic. Well, for me, every day is like a date with the brain. I often exclaim in my seminars that it is my romance with the brain that keeps me going all day long.

I was a victim of 'observer bias'. I observed my parents' careers (both in medicine) and jumped into this discipline without knowing the inner core of my brain's thinking type. I was a creator and innovator. I felt dry soon in my career, catering only to the patients. Each day was repetitive, dull, and boring. I felt accomplished, having been awarded thirteen gold medals and receiving a fat pay cheque, but never fulfilled.

I wanted to develop and work on a broad scale. Education and healthcare are the two pillars of humanity. The innovator/entrepreneur spirit was not allowing me to become complacent with my accomplishments. I will be frank and honest here. For the past eight years, there has not been a single weekend that I have had free to myself. The research for this book has been an eight-year-long journey. I am not tired but fuelled with a greater passion to now deliver this program to every single child on the planet. This desire aligns with my purpose-centric and innovative thinking brain type. This is the career synergy and success formula. You shall read about it more in the last bonus chapter.

I am a huge fan of whole-brain science proposed by Prof. Ned Herrmann and Prof. Dr. Kobus Neethling. This science has been instrumental in my life to help avoid the aftershocks that arise from not understanding people's behaviour, be it my boss, parents, friends, or colleagues. The science is so apt. The brain is divided into rational and limbic types. Rational is the thinking type and the limbic is the emotional seat. *Mybraindesign*® and the 'drivers of thinking' are re-worked versions of the whole-brain science but cater to career choices. The 'opportunity awareness quiz' and 'success signature experiments' are exclusively developed and dedicated to contributing cutting-edge information to the world beyond this known science.

Who is our main focus when we talk about a potential career choice? It is now Generation Alpha and whoever follows.

Generation Alpha (i.e., children born after 2010) are privileged and challenged at the same time. Over the course of my decade-long research, I have met thousands of parents. Most are worried about the future career choices of their children. They are struggling to catch up with the era. There are so many choices that even choosing the right option has become an analysis-paralysis affair for many.

Who should be picking up this book? If you are a parent, teacher, or adult struggling to identify the best-known career path for someone young, a post-college student struggling to fit or conform to your new degree, or a career counsellor helping others find their best career fit, this book is for you.

No science or scientific process is a fortune teller. Science is a dataset. A lot of reading between the lines is required. The logic can be the same but the interpretation of the logic can vary. We have hence built a pyramid (seven-level structure) to step out a successful career journey. Each level comes from years of dedicated research. I am grateful to my fellow researchers and colleagues for this book.

Neuroscience is both complex and easy at the same time. Complex until you do not get it right and simple once you get it right. I always exclaim that it is like mathematics. It seems puzzling when you do not get the right answer, though once solved, it is like a piece of cake.

If you are wondering whether this book offers yet another personality or aptitude assessment, let me clarify, it does not. Umpteen such tools are available on the internet, most for free, at least for the basic versions. There are commonly used tools in career choices such as the Holland Hexagon, MBTI®, Strong Interest Inventory®, and others. I have performed each of those and personally like them all. However, I am failing to understand the 'one-shot tells all' approach for the same persona. Yes, the

basic tool provides an understanding of personality, behaviour, interests, and aptitude. But what next? How do we drive home an understanding of more than 800 careers (common ones as well) to children, and believe me, to parents and teachers too? This is the essence of the pyramid of career success. It begins with the self-discovery assessment with *Mybraindesign*® and self-development as a continuum.

Mybraindesign® is our proprietary tool. It comprises more than thirty-five questions and is delivered online. We have validated and aptly curated it to suit children and adults. It is the foundation and backbone of our process.

Opportunity awareness, which is the next stage in the pyramid, is presented as a supplementary brain career quest set quiz for the junior and senior levels, which is available online on various e-commerce stores (from Brainforia, our parent company). This opens the door of curiosity towards careers. Once you are subliminally or subconsciously exposed to the words, you start to engage with those in real life. Why do you think most kids who are questioned about their career choices end up answering only a few options – pilot, teacher, astronaut, or in today's era, a YouTuber? It is because their brains are in reality seeing these professions in their lessons, daily life, and around them. Why does no one talk about being a nanotechnologist? Because none of these lessons drive home the awareness for such careers. Children only reflect their immediate reality.

There are seventeen different types of thinking proposed in the book. These are metaphoric extensions of the modelled divisions of the brain. Each of us has a unique combination of thinking pattern. Well, is it that simple that each of us harbours just one of the seventeen types of thinking brain? The answer is very interesting and I would urge you to go through Chapters 6, 7, and 8 to understand this concept.

What Are the Remaining Chapters All About?

The first chapter is a showcase of my life, the real reason why I am writing this book. The second chapter gives a broad outline of the need for career discovery tools and the right age to undergo the same. Following this, Chapter 3 talks about the available career discovery tools.

A lot of interesting neuroscience facts are relayed in between so that one can take them from theoretical assumptions to practical applications. A lovely mascot, Sir Ebrall (derived from cerebral), will take us through this interesting relay of information.

While Chapters 3 and 4 are dedicated to understanding the brain type of the Generation Alpha and the world of work that exists in the 21st century. This is the era of the information superhighway, where there are more Wi-Fi spots than drinking water spots, and more screen time than green time. The Covid-19 pandemic has accelerated the technological transformation to the remotest parts of the world.

The forthcoming generation will have careers in emerging fields such as cyber security, cryptocurrency, digital business, data science, etc. They will be lifelong learners, holding multiple jobs across multiple careers. More than 50% of the jobs that exist today are predicted to be automated in the near future. Robots are no longer potential or feasible, they are already here.

We need to equip ourselves and up-level our game in understanding the relevant shifts and changing roles of the workplace so that we can become exposed to them at the right pace and make them slowly merge into the realities of the new digital world. We must be able to support them through the transition. Starting a dialogue about career choice early in high school is a *must*.

We need the schools to build an expanded curriculum showcasing the demands of tomorrow so that young brains are primed to anticipate even the unexpected. In doing this, parents have an even bigger role to play. Having the time to be involved in their children's decisions and discussions about the future is important.

The last three chapters (4, 5 and 6), focus on the concepts of extracurricular activity or hobby crafting for the kids. What kind of hobbies should be offered to high schoolers that can align with their career choices? What is the life-design blueprint for a final career choice?

Some of the successful people in various fields have had their brains mapped and the appendix provides a review of these brain profiles. We are chasing the ABC for career success – the anatomical, biological, and cognitive bases for career success. We are inviting the stalwarts in their career fields and mapping them for the *Mybraindesign*® and the actual thirty-two channel brain EEG. The experimentation to understand the default brain wiring using this sophisticated approach is ongoing and we will be happy to present some more of the data on our website on a continual basis.

We want more *Mybraindesign*® career enthusiasts. Join us in this journey together. We are glad to welcome you! Let the future be clear and bright not just for you and the young people under your care, but for the world at large. Clarity breeds confidence and confidence brings *success* – and this is what this book is all about.

1

Arranged-Cum-Love Career: What a Dilemma!

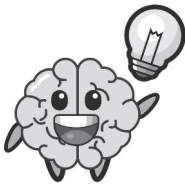
I love to offer the analogy of marriage when it comes to the dilemma of career choice. While arranged marriage in the western world may be unheard of, it remains a practice in many Asian countries. Arranged marriage is an institution where the boy and the girl do not opt to choose each other but their parents or siblings arrange the relationship. Career paths for children, when chosen years in advance by teachers, parents, peers, and sometimes grandparents, is an example of an arranged career. My career was chosen by my parents, both of whom were doctors. It's not that they were the dictators of my life, but because I had no clear picture of what I wanted to pursue even after finishing high school with fantastic marks, I entrusted the choice to them. Was this a wise move? Has everything in my life been great as a result of this choice?

We have two brains. One of them is a thinking rational brain while the other is a limbic or emotional brain. Simply put, one

loves a fact as it is and the other loves the meaning of it. We are essentially a complex mixture of both in various proportions.

Let me introduce you to Sir Ebrall who shall guide us and teach us more about the fun facts of neuroscience. I bet you will love him.

Sir Ebrall



We have evolved from creepy-crawly creatures to anatomically modern humans with a ton of cerebral cortex or folds helping us make intelligent decisions. I am sure you shall be curious enough to find out more about it as you read through the book.

The 'Zero to Hero' Choice

I feel so naive thinking of the past now in that I had no clue of what my career could look like. The only thing that I had some hunch about was that I was a creator. I could build things. But building things leads to what careers? I had zero clue. I would go on any number of fieldtrips with my parents, be it to the airport, hotel, hospital, or thermal power station, and on return, I would recreate exactly the same scene. I would consider the minutest details. I would make use of all household items to make sure the place that I visited was recreated in my home in the exact way that I had seen it.

I had inbuilt leadership qualities that would allow me to gather a few children around my home and play some innovative and fun games. I was not afraid. I was always ready to

experiment. I wanted to be a role model for other children. I was restless. I was quite intelligent and creative at the same time. I wanted to create something great, or rather anything great that could impact the lives of millions for good. This thought was constantly bothering me in my childhood. There was a feeling that my life was crafted to be a special purpose vehicle delivering something for the betterment and uplifting of people.

But I Had No Clue About My Career Choices or Life Choices

My parents were both in the medical field. I had fantastic marks in science at high school. My mother and I went to every person who could guide us in selecting the right career path. There were no career counsellors about twenty-six years back. There was no concept of a personality test. I had opted for the one and only aptitude assessment in Mumbai, India, about sixteen hours from my hometown. I was no Generation Alpha (i.e., born between the early 2010s and early 2020s) with access to the online information superhighway. I grew up without a mobile phone, laptop, television, or any form of advanced scientific assessment at my high school. The common dictum was if you score good marks you take up science and if not you opt for commerce.

There was a choice of pursuing a career in medicine or civil engineering. I was one of the top scholars in the state and was offered a scholarship to study in Singapore. Luckily, I had visited Singapore in my early teens and I could imagine what my life could be like in that country. The dilemma of choosing which career to follow was profound. Practising medicine could be done across the street in my hometown, while pursuing engineering would mean travelling to another state or country.

Medicine was offered free of cost to girls in my state. I didn't have to pay a dime to become a doctor. Economically, however, both the options matched. To choose between engineering and medicine was like picking an orange or apple just by the mere look of it. I had no clue about engineering although I had seen my distant uncle working as a civil engineer. The field of medicine was closely observed due to my parents' inclination and engagement in that field.

The Title Fight: Dr. or Er?

What did I finally end up choosing? You must be wondering. The dilemma was quite disturbing. On the one hand, there was engineering and on the other end medicine. I can still remember the time of day when right at the last hour the bell rang and I was called for my final choice. The stress of that final hour was so immense that it formed a rock-solid memory in my brain. Life seemed so fragile for a moment, frenzied with fear of making the wrong choice. All the 'what if' questions were popping like lilies in the brain.

My whole family went into a unique intellectual drama followed by the trauma of the choice. I ended up doing medicine. You could say the choice went well. I was the most comfortable student in medicine. I used to be the hero of the class. I could memorise anatomy and physiology so well that professors used to talk about setting a unique paper challenging my understanding. I was like a fish in water. I was at the top of my graduation class and had the luxury to choose my postgraduate path.

Because I had no fine motor skills and it was clear that I could not be a surgeon. Internal or general medicine was my only love and finishing it was a piece of cake . I was a

topper all throughout my career in medicine with over thirteen gold medals/prizes. I was very hardworking and diligent in my endeavours to learn medicine. I pursued five years of a Bachelor of Medicine, Bachelor of Surgery (MBBS), which is a basic medical degree followed by a three-year postgraduate degree in medicine (MD).

There is Always More to Medicine

The real-life post-MD medicine started and I found myself again questioning the future. Having an MD was not enough for me. I wanted to challenge myself to the best available course in medicine. My intelligence wanted to play with fire. Neurology was considered to be the most difficult subject for most students. Even good students dreaded neurology cases. But I like to take challenges head-on. The funniest part of my career journey is that the choice of neurology was a mere accident. My roommate was so passionate about neurology that she used to bombard me with questions on neurology pretty much each day and night. I had no choice but to listen to her forced teachings. Destiny played hard. She could not opt for the seat due to family issues while I was able to join the super-specialty program almost immediately. I still remember her vivid expression of congratulating me to live her dream. I was so taken aback at the news of her not being able to pursue neurology. Again, man proposes but God can dispose of it. This makes you wonder and delve into many other philosophical questions.

My journey in neurology for about four years was unique and exciting. I met some fantastic people as teachers and friends. I was able to understand that the brain is my first love. I was

awe-struck by the sheer power of the brain. I was more inclined to know the physiology of the brain's functions than to limit myself to fixing broken brains. I really want to kindle the normal lives to lead a path of glory and success.

Neuroscience has hidden gems. Knowing how your brain works can make you tap its maximum potential powers. The mascot Sir Ebrall shall be giving us a lot of tips throughout the book and will teach us more about the brain.

My Life in a Nutshell

Somebody has rightly said 'Life is all about choices we make'. The decisions we take every single day, big or small, impact our lives in one way or another and determine how our coming years shall unfold. To summarise my journey across the five continents today sounds so easy. I completed my master's degree in medicine and neurology in Mumbai, India. I further completed my stroke fellowship in Calgary, Canada. I worked in central Africa for a few years. I pursued a Master of Business Administration (MBA) at Cambridge, UK. I had a summer stint with the United Nations Non-Communicable Disease (UNNCD) program in Geneva. For the last several years I have been based in Dubai, United Arab Emirates (UAE), working as a medical director and a specialist neurologist for RAK Hospital.

Now you may be wondering how a degree in business (MBA) came up in the career of a neurologist and specialist in paralytic stroke medicine. You asked the right question. I was accomplished but not content. After finishing all these studies, I still had questions lingering in my mind. Am I going to deliver to the world my passion? Am I steering my career path to the best of my abilities? Will I be working on a larger scale?

Life is all about purpose and meaning. Within me was a burning passion to work on a broad scale. An impact so big that many lives had to be touched by my work. The options in front of me were clear – research, working as an entrepreneur, author/teacher, and working for a small organisation creating a big impact. Later you will realise these options exactly match the four sides of the brain's process drivers.

I never wanted a typical nine-to-five job. I wanted excitement, to travel and meet new people, to create new programs that could impact people at large. I quickly understood being a neurologist was not going to give me any of the above. The path to experimentation was unclear. Pursuing a very traditional neurology career and trying now to work on a much broader scale? This plan itself sounded like a pun. I was sure I wanted to do the extraordinary out of the neurology career. **I knew the *why*, but I did not know the *how*.**

Do you Follow Destiny or Does it Follow You?

I always wondered who follows – do you follow destiny or does destiny follow you? This is a deep philosophical question. This book, however, is not about this question. This book is a testimony to the navigation across the choices in one's career path. The crossroads in my own career and the experiment of navigating a path from medicine to neurology to stroke medicine to an MBA testify to this effort.

I was a hard worker all throughout my career. After becoming an accomplished neurologist I realised there was something missing in my life. Yes, I was earning very well. I could get jobs across the globe. I had the flexibility of choices. There were only about 5,000 stroke specialists around the world when I graduated. The

demand-supply ratio was highly skewed. I could go back to India and pursue a private career establishing my own centre. Or, I could easily stay in Canada and pursue a research path.

Money is Not Everything in Life

The luxury of the choices was immense. How many of you reading the book feel accomplished with great pay cheques but feel empty within? You feel that you are meant to do something completely different and derive your joy from something that is far removed from your current job role.

Upon deep reflection over the course of six months and taking up about seventy-two psychometric tests through hundreds of Google sites, some free but mostly paid for, I understood that I am indeed a creator. I am a rebel. I love to invent. I love to build and develop. I like to experiment. I blew thousands of dollars meeting hundreds of career coaches and doing multiple analyses and tests in the pursuit of finding my true purpose. I have loads of test results in my house. This was the time immediately following my fellowship for stroke neurology. I took a complete six-month break. *I wanted to be sure of my next go-to path.*

The analysis of self-discovery was profound. It clearly set the path of my life. For once, I was convinced that the childhood hunch was indeed true. I am meant to create a mission-driven business that can upscale to reach thousands of people.

Working on my self-discovery led me to an idea about reshaping and developing the tools and/or processes that would enable me to help many students and people stuck in their careers. Science helped me de-clutter my own career path. I was convinced that the formula could help so many others stuck in their own career paths. I started to experiment with one of the tools

of whole-brain science helping me to derive cognitive preferences. I started to work on something that I had no idea would take a mammoth shape. I had to work on a huge sample size. I needed to validate the tool statistically. I was very fortunate to have some great mentors in the process.

Having a Purpose in Life is Magical

My purpose was sealed. It was clear that I would be working to help the young school-goers find their best path forward. New energy pulsed down my spine to wake me every single day towards this goal. While I carried on with my research about the science of career choices, I had some social pressures. My mother went through post-operative depression which took a toll on my family. I was the sole breadwinner at that point in time when my father had to leave his work to support my mother. We experienced quite difficult years then. I had no option but to join a traditional nine-to-five job again in Mumbai. But believe me, I was terrified of working in a traditional setting. There was no excitement. I felt stifled despite being paid well. The urge to not sit in one place without experimentation was becoming more intense day after day. I was struggling to keep my feelings at bay. However, I was pulling each day praying I could be back to experimentation and do something completely out of the ordinary. Once my family problems began to settle after a year, I decided to put my CV on LinkedIn, which was quite a new baby on board in India. I asked to join any country that could give me a challenging non-traditional job role in neurology or stroke medicine.

I received a call from a man within two days of posting my CV. He invited me for an interview without disclosing where the

job would be located. He was a stunning man, clad in a black suit and tie. He was well-spoken and asked me for a compensation plan. I was so fed up with India that I threw a number twenty times my salary at the time. My friend who had accompanied me looked at my face in awe. She must have been wondering whether I had lost my marbles or if I was trying to pitch the ball out of the court.

To our utter surprise, the man agreed to that price. Until about an hour into the interview, there was no clue where the job was and what kind of job it was. Of course, it was related to neurology, but in what capacity, and where?

He finally declared that his hospital was in Kinshasa, Democratic Republic of Congo, Africa. I immediately looked at my friend and asked have you heard the name of the country? She silently whispered, no. While the discussion was now all about the ease and facility which would be provided in Congo, I was in two minds. I asked for some time to conduct my due diligence. The first response from anyone who heard my story exclaimed I was crazy. They said that enough jobs existed in India and why would I leave my family and go all the way to central Africa? They were fearful of wars, malaria, and other communicable diseases.

I started to research more about the central African region. I was excited to go to a new place and meet new people. I soon learned that French was compulsory to be able to join the job. I had no knowledge of French and the only way to learn the language was to start watching French movies. I started to do that silently without telling my family. My friends were not a party to my plan either. Obviously, who would agree a few years back to pack bags for a country that was war-stricken?

The Silent Gene Speaks Up One Day

I was very happy in my new role in Africa. I met some of the most inspiring people in my life. I was so very welcomed to the country. I fell in love with the natural resources that the country offered. I could see hundreds of patients a day, travel to far and deep places, and eat some exotic foods. I never once felt out of place. While I was enjoying the work, I still was brewing the hunger for taking my research to the next level. The deep urge to bring out my career science choice research to the world in the form of a scalable and social business started to haunt me. I constantly worked on the weekends towards that goal. I never took a weekend off, yet never felt drained as the research gave me enough fire to run for the next week. I started to do pop-ups (unlike start-ups) – small entrepreneurial stints to support the idea. I opened a company and was joined by my then friend-cum-teacher. The experiments led me to gain exposure to the entrepreneurial demands and nuances.

The Human Brain is New Each Day

I have always believed that pushing new boundaries is the driving purpose of the human brain. We have not stopped creating since the beginning of evolution. Our brains have constantly been hunting new pastures. How could I be complacent sitting all day and doing a nine-to-five job? My brain was not at ease accepting this daily plan. I had no fortune or other skills to make a venture in India successful. The side hustle taught me that my skills were far short of my dreams.

One Message Was Very Loud and Clear. I Had to Upskill. I Needed to Learn Management Skills. I Had to Do an MBA.

I started researching the business schools and it was very clear that I should pursue an MBA from a top college in the world. I was dissuaded by my colleagues that I was too old for business school. Yes, medical science involves many years of study. Why would a school reject me merely for my age? I was committed to learning management skills so that I could create a revolution in the science of self-discovery. I applied to the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Oxford, Stanford, Cambridge, IE Business School, and Institut Européen d'Administration des Affaires (INSEAD). I had to redo the Graduate Management Admission Test (GMAT) exam after many years of being out of touch with mathematics and English. I had to learn from scratch how to present my dreams in essay form so that I could kickstart my journey into one of the top MBA schools. I was accepted at IE, Cambridge, and HEC Paris and waitlisted at MIT. My dream was coming true, slowly but surely.

My Dream Comes True

Receiving a letter of acceptance from Cambridge with scholarship was the best thing in my life. The ambition of doing an MBA after a very long medicine career was indeed not an easy one. I was about to take up something where I may not be successful. I was about to challenge many people's advice that it was foolish to invest money and a year of my life in studying a new discipline after all my years at the grindstone in medicine. It is easy to live

other people's dreams but to live one's own dream takes courage and grit. People may want something out of you but what you wish for and want is the crucial thing in life.

I Was Finally Not Just a Brain Plumber

I thoroughly enjoyed the MBA program. I was able to navigate my way through corporate finance with ease alongside most other subjects I had never before studied. It was a true calling. I could immediately draw my own plan that in the medium-term I would lead an organisation and in the long-term work on my research to impact millions globally. I kept my entrepreneurial spirit alive throughout the course and in the process learned a lot. I was able to meet so many inspiring people in life. Although the Covid-19 pandemic hit during the last term making contact learning impossible, Zoom allowed it all to happen virtually.

Cambridge is Magical

Cambridge is a beautiful city and the Judge Business School is one of its most magical places. I always say magical places bring magic to your life. Cambridge is one such place. The one year at Cambridge opened the pathway for management and executive leadership in the UAE and gave me all the right skills to pursue my dream of impacting lives on a broad scale.

All's Well That Ends Well

My real calling is to help children who are confused about their career prospects. I was able to translate all my research into a program called *Mybraindesign*®. My real-life career insights led me to develop the seven levels of success for a career choice. I finally embarked on the journey that I feel I am meant to deliver in this lifetime. I want to be the torch-bearer of a revolution in finding the purpose for young teenagers or high school students.

Legacy for Life in Career Choice Science

This book is the product of my constant search for finding the right career path through self-discovery. I have been working relentlessly for over eight years to develop the formula, since the time of realising my career discontentment. I have interviewed thousands of parents and students in the process of my self-discovery. I was part of all the career forums in the world. I studied every single test with the finest of details. I took interviews with successful people in various fields and mapped their brain preferences. *Mybraindesign*® was a research effort that lasted eight long years. It was refined time and again. It was perfected with effort.

Ikigai: Mine to Yours – the Final Summary

This book and the accompanying program are a testimony to the work of a desperate entrepreneur who was searching

for her own *Ikigai*-purpose in life. *Ikigai* is a Japanese word. It essentially refers to something that gives a person a sense of person, a reason for living. I had no idea that doing the research for my own career would lead me to design a program for high school and college graduates worldwide. My enthusiasm knew no bounds when a lot of schools and other career counselling centres started to value my work. They opted to commission me and the team for career coaching worldwide. My vision solidified and I would become a pioneer in building a school for future readiness.

Success and Contentment May Not Go Hand in Hand

While being content is to definitely be successful, being successful may not require one to be content. This was a strong message for my own life. I always felt that the science of self-discovery could help anyone who wished to create magic in their life. The *Mybraindesign*® program and the career science methodology can impact the lives of millions of children. Understanding the cognitive preferences and navigating life through conscious decisions is key.

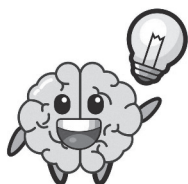
Learning the fundamentals of neuroscience has been a key pillar of my success. I always exclaim, ***it is my romance with the brain***. Neuroscience has a lot that remains unexplored, and while much has already been discovered, this is not delivered to the world in simple formula sets. This book allows me to present the neuroscience-based processes for helping the Generation Alphas choose a career fit for their brain preferences.

The World Needs Magical Bagpipers to Lead as We Move Through the 21st Century.

My idea is plain and simple. When you work in a profession or towards a purpose that fits your brain preferences, you will create magic. I worked on my best brain preferences and finally chose a purpose-driven mission in life. I had to navigate through rough waters. I want to make those waters calm and smooth for you. Let us start the journey together. I am excited and I hope you are too!

Walk the Talk

1. **Visioneering.** Sit comfortably. Close your eyes and picture yourself on a forward time scale. Where do you see yourself in five years, ten years, and fifteen years? What are you doing? Who is around you? What have you created? Who is celebrating your existence? What is the world's reaction? How are you feeling?



Sir Ebrall's tip: The brain cannot differentiate between a real and visualised event. Repeatedly doing this exercise will, therefore, make the brain believe the truth and indeed you can be that. This is the power of *visioneering* – nothing but the secret behind Rhonda Byrnes' *Secret*.

If you are a parent, do the same exercise for your children. Think of where you see them in five years, ten years, and

fifteen years. Make them do the same exercise. Of course, they may think anything radical which is completely fine.

2. **What is your personal SWOT?** Describe your strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats, that impact your career. Punch at least 5 points in each section.

Storyselling. Storytelling is very powerful. In fact, storytelling is also *storyselling*. We are all salespeople. Daniel Pink reinforces the same idea in his book '*To Sell is Human*'. I am selling healthy eating and exercise every single day to my patients. What are you selling? You can share with us your career victory story at www.mybraindesign.org

